

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader moving closer to the model — shipping an AI copilot skill, an end-to-end AI fundraising ecosystem, and a design-system-as-API

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

EMAIL

hello@treppmann.design

PORTFOLIO

treppmann.design/work?fin-ai-design-leader

LINKEDIN

linkedin.com/in/tobiastreppmann

GITHUB

github.com/tobystereo

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University
2022 – Present

B.A. Theology (equiv.)

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching; design-thinking and product-strategy consulting for non-profits, religious organisations, and mission-driven ventures.

PROFILE

Design leader who has moved closer and closer to the model over the past year. Currently at Bibel TV shipping an MS Copilot skill for the customer-support team (handbook-as-context, escalation as first-class output, human keeps every send decision) and an end-to-end AI fundraising ecosystem built solo — letter-performance analysis, a Claude Project with a multi-turn clarifying-question loop, a web prototype, and a Claude skill that carries the same voice into in-app notifications, web banners, and video scripts. Alongside: agentic engineering as a shipped design practice (AI-coded prototypes consumed directly by engineering; days-to-hours iteration) and a design-system-as-API (Android live, Figma live via plugin, iOS/web ready) that treats quality as how things work. 15+ years leading design — five-year director tenure at Datameer across Germany + NYC (top US/CA/UK banks and insurers); Senior Leadership Team member at Ninox, where I designed the vibe-coding split-screen direct-manipulation onboarding model with the CEO and technical co-founder before product handoff; Head of Platform and Design at ChurchDesk shipping AI alt-text (95% WCAG 2.1 coverage) under GDPR-plus church data-protection law. Berlin-based; German native, English C2; builder DNA extends into indie work.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (B2C faith-media platform across mobile, web, and connected TV) · Hamburg (2 days/week) + Berlin (Remote), Germany

- Shipped an MS Copilot skill for the customer-support team that drafts replies to viewer letters and emails against the CS handbook as context; scoped what the skill loads, defined "good draft" with the CS team before prompt-tuning, kept the human send-decision absolute, made escalation a first-class output for acute-crisis messages (routes out rather than drafts). Live in production; introduced through self-testing followed by 1:1 sessions with the CS team; adopted qualitatively across the seniority-and-scepticism spectrum
- Built the AI fundraising ecosystem end-to-end, solo — analysed past letters and their performance to identify seasonality and style patterns separating over- from under-performers; encoded the analysis and style guide into a Claude Project with a multi-turn clarifying-question loop before generation (not single-shot); built a web prototype for the generation flow; built a Claude skill producing follow-up content across three surfaces — in-app notifications, web banners, and video scripts. Analysis, prompt-engineering, prototype, and skill work all shipped by me
- Introduced agentic engineering as design practice — designed the new Bibel TV experience first as a web prototype, then as an Android app prototype, using AI-assisted coding tools on real Bibel TV APIs; engineering consumes prototype code directly; ~70% of AI-generated code ships with minor modifications; iteration speed collapsed from days through spec-and-handoff to hours in working code. Actively evangelising the practice across the team
- Established the design system as an API — DTCG-standard token repository; three-tier hierarchy (global primitives → semantic → component); Style Dictionary build; multi-platform sync (Android live, Figma live via plugin, iOS/web endpoints ready); architecture supports server-driven UI. One commit propagates to every platform automatically — consistency enforced by structure, not coordination
- Leading the mobile app redesign across iOS / Android / web / connected TV for engagement and retention; partnering with engineering on the experimentation framework and A/B testing infrastructure for rapid iteration; running the "Designing with and for AI" workshop series with the team as internal AI-adoption practice

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk GmbH (European church-management SaaS across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Shipped AI alt-text generation for EU accessibility compliance — 95% WCAG 2.1 coverage in production under GDPR + Protestant/Catholic church data-protection law across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH — production AI in a regulated environment. Established automated accessibility design processes across customer-facing content
- Delivered a suite of CS-workflow modules to help client churches automate remote processes: shared inbox with multi-user team-inbox routing, case-management ticket system, and booking system for core church processes; parish staff as agent-equivalent users — customer-support-domain adjacency
- Dual PM + Design on the Booking System (€20k, 2-month): reframed scope from "funeral-booking feature" into a booking capability deeply integrated into the platform; owned build-vs-buy and standalone-vs-integrated decisions. 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% booking acceptance rate; became core platform feature beyond the initial Hessen region (20+ cemeteries; multi-stakeholder coordination across funeral homes, pastors, cemeteries, families)
- Managed 1 direct report (designer); main customer-facing contact for the launch parish; simplified communication channels between product, design, and engineering

- Designed the vibe-coding A

- Designed the vibe-coding AI onboarding model with Ninox's CEO and technical co-founder in founder-led stealth, before the initiative was handed to the product team: prompt-to-database with split-screen direct manipulation; AI-generated schema renders into the real Ninox data-model editor (not a chat preview); chat and direct manipulation surface co-exist. First schema is wrong handled as the normal case. Adopted as basis for the public Airtable (Feb 2026) by user agency principle explicit: "show output, allow users to edit"

product leadership. Joined member with parity to product, engineering, and commercial at executive level; managed 5 direct reports including a design lead (1 writer among them); established shared governance of the design system across 4 designers. Engineering analysis

12 Coached the design lead through a difficult engineering-lead partnership — reframed “what’s wrong with that person?” as “what’s wrong with our system?” Personally led the design meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking, written decisions) to include a sidelined

neurodivergent engineer, who became one of the strongest contributors; structured habits spread beyond the original accommodation and became team norm

• Made performance calls in both directions: hired 1 designer + 1 writer, let go 1 designer + 1 writer; actively shaped team composition delivering final design work for the earlier interim Head of Product period (2023) folded into this tenure

note — independent web design and front-end development for
Product & UX Strategist 2021 – 2022

Hypoport Hub SE (Hypoport Group shared service center; service-to-product transformation) Berlin / Lübeck, 2010-2011

Partnered with the executive team to provide internal services at the Hypoport Group's shared service center; transformed individualised, case-by-case support into a standardised, scalable service catalog. Worked with the IT department on ITSM / service-desk implementation — internal operations tooling for the rest of the Group

- Applied UX, Agile, and prod

- Applied UX, Agile, and product methodologies to a service organisation (not software design); designed and delivered design-thinking training programs for executive leadership and service teams; primary stakeholder contact presenting to executives

• skill for customer support; end-to-end AI fundraising ecosystem —
 + web prototype + Claude skill for in-app / web / video surfaces) •
Director of Design (AI-driven direct manipulation) • Human-in-the-
 loop • **2016 – 2021**
 • **Partner, GmbH Collaborative big data analytics platform for top US / CA / UK banks & insurers)** Germany &
 • **Partner, USA** cross-Atlantic
 • Escalation as first-class agent output • Production AI in regulated
 • **GDPR the design team across Germany and NYC for 5 years** • 6-hour time-zone gap; established a time-boxed
 strategic-initiatives methodology (persona development, lightweight design projects) to balance strategic and

Director of Design

- **Designed and prototyped a high-data-analytics platform for top US / CA / UK banks & insurers** (Germany & USA across Atlantic)
- Escalated as first-class agent output · Production AI in regulated
- **Guided the design team across Germany and NYC for 6 years** for 6-hour time-zone gap; established a time-boxed strategic-initiatives methodology (persona development, lighthouse design projects) to balance strategic and tactical work across the difference; sustained design consistency through written decisions and async rituals
- Redesigned the collaborative data-analytics platform for data engineers, analysts, and business users at top US, Canadian, and UK banks and insurers in a strict regulatory environment; pioneered iterative user-testing.com screening to reach hard-to-reach regulated personas; built the design system from scratch
- Elevated design from execution-focused function to strategic business partner; secured executive support for user research initiatives in the regulated industry context; measurably increased UX maturity within the practice (Claude Code AI-coded prototypes consumed directly by
- Production · Prototype-in-real-code (React Native, Swift, Kotlin, real

or ICs

companies (Datameer / Ninox / ChurchDesk / Bibel TV) · Senior
 ching a design lead through stakeholder conflict · Managing peer-
 calls in both directions (hired 1 designer + 1 writer, let go 1 designer
 process design · CEO + technical co-founder direct collaboration
 nance design systems

Engineering

[nat](#) · [Three-tier token hierarchies \(global / semantic / component\)](#) · [Web / Connected TV](#) · [Style Dictionary](#) · [Tokens Studio](#) · [OKLCH](#) · [Storybook](#) · [Figma Variables](#) · [Git-based token repos](#) · [Engineering-handoff workflows](#) · [SwiftUI](#) · [HTML / CSS / TypeScript](#)

Team Operations

cycles · Iterative user testing · Screening for hard-to-reach input · Multi-stakeholder validation calls · Cross-timezone look · Time-boxed strategic-initiatives methodology · Written-first Control, Cognitive Load Reduction, Progressive Disclosure) · Infrastructure · Metric ownership (70% / 90% / 95% / measured UX